

**NAME OF SCHOOL: MATER MISERICORDIAE SECONDARY SCHOOL,
RUMOMASI**

TERM: FIRST 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: ONE

CLASS: SS3

SUBJECT: Government

TOPIC: Pre-Colonial Nigerian States

Introduction

- Before colonial rule, Nigeria was organised into empires, kingdoms, city-states and chiefdoms with well-developed systems of government. The major states were the Oyo Empire, Benin, Kanem-Bornu, Sokoto Caliphate, the Igbo societies and the Hausa city-states.

The main pre-colonial states

- **Oyo Empire (Yoruba)** — the Alaafin was the political head with the Oyomesi (council of chiefs) and the Bashorun as checks; the empire grew rich from trade and cavalry.
- **Benin Kingdom (Edo)** — the Oba ruled with the Uzama (hereditary chiefs), the Eghosa and the Iwebo; famous for brass art and a centralised administration.
- **Kanem-Bornu (Lake Chad)** — the Mai was the ruler, with the Magira (queen mother) and a council; the Trans-Saharan trade and Islam shaped it.
- **Sokoto Caliphate** — founded by Uthman dan Fodio (1804–1810); the Caliph (Sarkin Musulmi) headed the empire of emirates, each with an Emir applying Sharia.
- **Igbo societies** — decentralised: the village assembly and council of elders (Ozo title holders) ruled by consensus; the Ofala of Onitsha and the Eze of Nri were notable exceptions.

Features of pre-colonial government

- They had constitutions (customs and traditions), separation of functions (the Alaafin vs Oyomesi checks), rule of law (customary law), elections indirectly (oracle, primogeniture, selection by chiefs), taxation (tribute), and courts. Their weakness: no written records and vulnerability to slave raiding and internal wars.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. Name four pre-colonial Nigerian states.
2. What was the Alaafin's relationship with the Oyomesi?
3. Describe the political system of the Igbo.
4. How did the Sokoto Caliphate govern its emirates?

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TERM: FIRST 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: TWO

CLASS: SS3

SUBJECT: Government

TOPIC: The Civil War & Reconciliation

Introduction

- The Nigerian Civil War (1967–1970) followed the secession of the Eastern Region as the Republic of Biafra. It was fought over the coup and counter-coup of 1966, the massacre of Easterners in the North, and the struggle over oil revenues and federal power.

Causes

- The 1966 military coups and the breakdown of trust between ethnic groups; the anti-Igbo pogroms in the North; the unilateral declaration of Biafra (30 May 1967) by Colonel Odumegwu Ojukwu; the federal blockade and the dispute over oil revenue allocation; the struggle for control of the central government.

Course and effects

- The war raged for 30 months ('the Nigeria–Biafra war') with heavy fighting in the Mid-West, the Rivers and the South-East; starvation and famine ('no victor, no vanquished' is often quoted) killed many civilians. Effects: loss of lives (estimated 1–3 million, mostly from hunger), destruction of industries and infrastructure, inflation, and deep ethnic wounds.

Reconciliation and lessons

- The war ended in January 1970 with the surrender of Biafra, and General Yakubu Gowon declared 'no victor, no vanquished'. Reconciliation was pursued through reintegration, 'reconstruction, reconciliation and rehabilitation' (the 3Rs), creation of more states, and the Federal Character principle in the constitution. Lesson: dialogue, justice, fairness and unity are precious; war destroys all sides.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. State three causes of the Nigerian Civil War.
2. When was Biafra declared and by whom?
3. Mention three effects of the war.
4. How was reconciliation achieved after 1970?

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TERM: FIRST 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: THREE

CLASS: SS3

SUBJECT: Government

TOPIC: Nigeria's Foreign Policy

Introduction

- Foreign policy is the sum of a country's goals and actions in international relations. Nigeria's foreign policy is guided by the constitution and articulated in the concept of 'Africa as the centrepiece of Nigeria's foreign policy'.

Objectives and principles

- The main principles: respect for the sovereignty and territorial integrity of states; non-interference in the internal affairs of other states; support for the independence of African states; promotion of African unity and development; peaceful settlement of disputes; support for international law and the UN; protection of Nigerians abroad; promotion of economic cooperation.

Policy instruments

- Diplomacy through missions abroad; membership of international organisations (UN, AU, ECOWAS, OPEC, Commonwealth, NAM); economic diplomacy (trade, investment, oil); military assistance and peacekeeping; cultural relations; and the media.

Major achievements

- Nigeria's leading role in the formation of ECOWAS (1975), peacekeeping in the Congo, Liberia (ECOMOG), Sierra Leone and The Gambia; the decolonisation struggle for Angola, Mozambique and Zimbabwe; debt relief campaigns; leadership in the AU; hosting of the UN headquarters in Africa's debates; and shuttle diplomacy for African conflicts.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. Define foreign policy.
2. What is 'Africa as the centrepiece' of Nigeria's foreign policy?
3. List three principles of Nigeria's foreign policy.
4. Mention two achievements of Nigeria's peacekeeping efforts.

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TERM: FIRST 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: FOUR

CLASS: SS3

SUBJECT: Government

TOPIC: African Union & ECOWAS

Introduction

- The African Union (AU) is the continental organisation of African states, and ECOWAS is the regional economic community of West Africa. Both promote unity, peace and development.

The African Union

- Founded in 2002 in Durban as the successor of the OAU (1963). Organs: the Assembly of Heads of State (highest), the Executive Council, the Commission, the Pan-African Parliament, the Court of Justice, the Peace and Security Council and specialised agencies. Objectives: unity, solidarity and cooperation among African states; accelerating integration; defending sovereignty; promoting human rights and democratic governance; and Agenda 2063 for sustainable development. Achievements: peacekeeping in Darfur and Somalia, the African Standby Force, and the African Continental Free Trade Area (AfCFTA).

ECOWAS

- Founded by the Treaty of Lagos in 1975 — 15 member states. Objectives: economic integration (free movement of persons, goods and services; a common market; a single currency — the eco); and political cooperation (peace and security). Institutions: the Authority of Heads of State, the Commission, the Parliament (in Abuja), the Court of Justice, ECOWAS Bank for Investment and Development, and ECOMOG (the peacekeeping force that intervened in Liberia and Sierra Leone). Problems: uneven implementation, border closures against free movement, multiple currencies and coups.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. When was the AU founded and what did it replace?
2. Name three organs of the AU.
3. State two objectives of ECOWAS.
4. What is ECOMOG and in which two countries did it intervene?

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TERM: FIRST 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: FIVE

CLASS: SS3

SUBJECT: Government

TOPIC: The Nigerian Constitution & Fundamental Rights (Revision)

Introduction

- This week consolidates the constitutional studies of the term: the supremacy of the constitution, the separation of powers and the fundamental rights every Nigerian enjoys under Chapter IV of the 1999 Constitution (as amended).

Key constitutional features

- **Supremacy** — the constitution is the highest law; any law inconsistent with it is void.
Federalism — power is shared between the Federal Government and 36 states plus the FCT. **Three organs** — the legislature (National Assembly), the executive (President and ministers) and the judiciary (courts), with checks and balances. **Amendment** — requires two-thirds of both chambers and two-thirds of the state houses of assembly.

Fundamental rights

- Right to life; dignity of the human person; personal liberty; fair hearing; private and family life; freedom of thought, conscience and religion; freedom of expression and the press; peaceful assembly and association; freedom of movement; freedom from discrimination. Rights are enforceable in court (fundamental rights enforcement procedure) and may be restricted only by law for public safety, order, health or morality.

Citizenship and duties

- Citizenship by birth, registration or naturalisation. Duties: obey the law, pay taxes, defend the country, vote, respect the rights of others, keep public property and participate in national service (NYSC).

CLASS EVALUATION

1. What is the supremacy of the constitution?
2. How is the Nigerian constitution amended?
3. List four fundamental rights.
4. State four duties of a Nigerian citizen.

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TERM: FIRST 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: SIX

CLASS: SS3

SUBJECT: Government

TOPIC: Public Service & Administration (Revision)

Introduction

- The public service is the body of officials that implements government policies and delivers public services — the civil service, the military and the police, parastatals and public corporations.

Structure and functions

- The federal civil service is organised into ministries (Health, Education, Finance, Defence...), departments and agencies, headed by the President at the top, then ministers, permanent secretaries, directors and other officers. The civil service advises the government, implements policies, prepares the budget, collects revenue, keeps records and delivers services.

Principles

- Politically neutral and permanent; anonymous; impartial; based on merit, promotion and discipline; accountable to the government and the public.

Problems and reforms

- Red tape and delay; corruption; inefficiency and poor morale; over-staffing; political interference; inadequate funding and training. Reforms: the Udoji Commission (1974), the Civil Service Reforms of 1988, due process and the Bureau of Public Procurement, the SERVICOM programme and the Treasury Single Account (TSA).

CLASS EVALUATION

1. Define the public service.
2. State four functions of the civil service.
3. Mention four principles of the civil service.
4. List three problems of the Nigerian public service and one reform each.